

COMBINATION WEAPONS

Throughout history, arms-makers have tried to combine the benefits of more than one weapon. Sometimes these were attempts to produce practical military weapons, but often these hybrid weapons were made as objects of interest and technical curiosity. Combining two weapons would often compromise the effectiveness of both, but they could be splendidly decorative, even if they were not very practical. Firearms were frequently attached to other kinds of weapon, with the idea that a staff weapon, shield, or sword might gain additional potency.

▼ HALBERD WITH TWO WHEEL-LOCK MECHANISMS

Date c.1590

Origin Germany

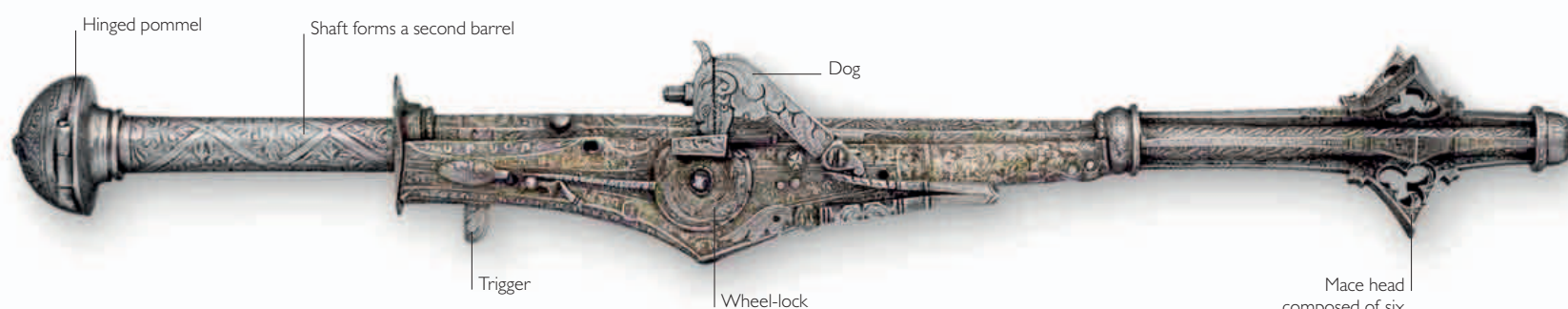
Length 27¼in (69.1cm)

Caliber .33in (.83cm)

This is a ceremonial halberd equipped with a double-barreled wheel-lock pistol. The pistol barrels are octagonal and mounted on either side of the leaf-shaped blade. The whole gun is etched and partly gilt with strap and scroll-work, the ax and fluke of the head having additional trophies of arms.



FULL VIEW



▲ MACE WHEEL-LOCK

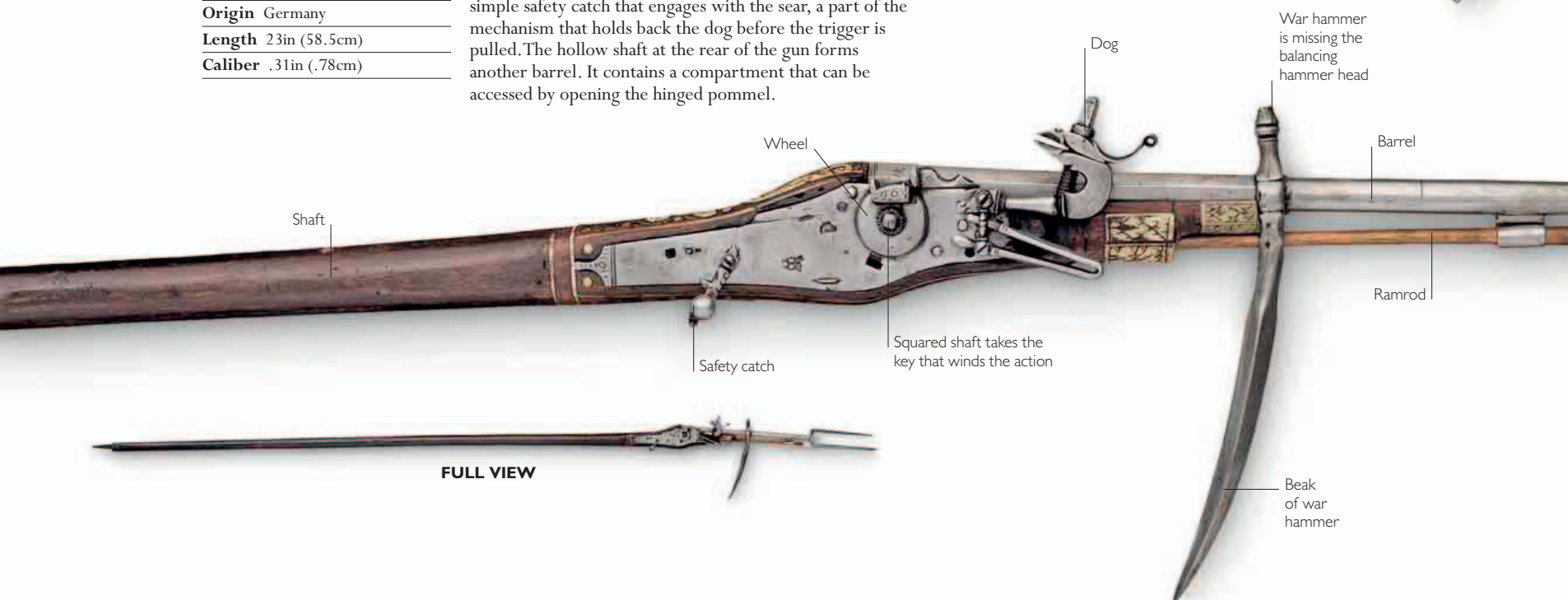
Date c.1560

Origin Germany

Length 23in (58.5cm)

Caliber .31in (.78cm)

The head of this wheel-lock pistol has six pointed flanges, each pierced with a trefoil shape. The lock incorporates a simple safety catch that engages with the sear, a part of the mechanism that holds back the dog before the trigger is pulled. The hollow shaft at the rear of the gun forms another barrel. It contains a compartment that can be accessed by opening the hinged pommel.



FULL VIEW